

SCIENCE ADVENTURE

Characteristics & Life Processes of Living Things

GRADE 3

What makes something alive?



Let's Explore!

Look around your classroom or community. Which things do you think are alive?

Point, guess, and tell a friend WHY!

I THINK IT IS ALIVE!



What Are Living Things?

Living things have special characteristics that make them different from nonliving things.

GROW & CHANGE

RESPOND to their environment

REPRODUCE — have babies or seeds

CARRY OUT life processes

Examples: people • dogs • trees • flowers • birds



Living vs Nonliving Things



LIVING THINGS

- ✓ Grow and change
- ✓ Respond to the environment
- ✓ Reproduce
- ✓ Need the right conditions to live



NONLIVING THINGS

- × Do not grow by themselves
- × Do not respond like living things
- × Do not reproduce
- × Do not carry out life processes

Local Examples



Life Process 1: Growth & Change

Living things grow and change over time.

A tiny seed can become a big flowering plant!

WATCH THE CHANGES!



SEED → SPROUT → PLANT

Life Process 2: Response

Living things notice and respond to changes around them.

Example: A plant grows toward sunlight.

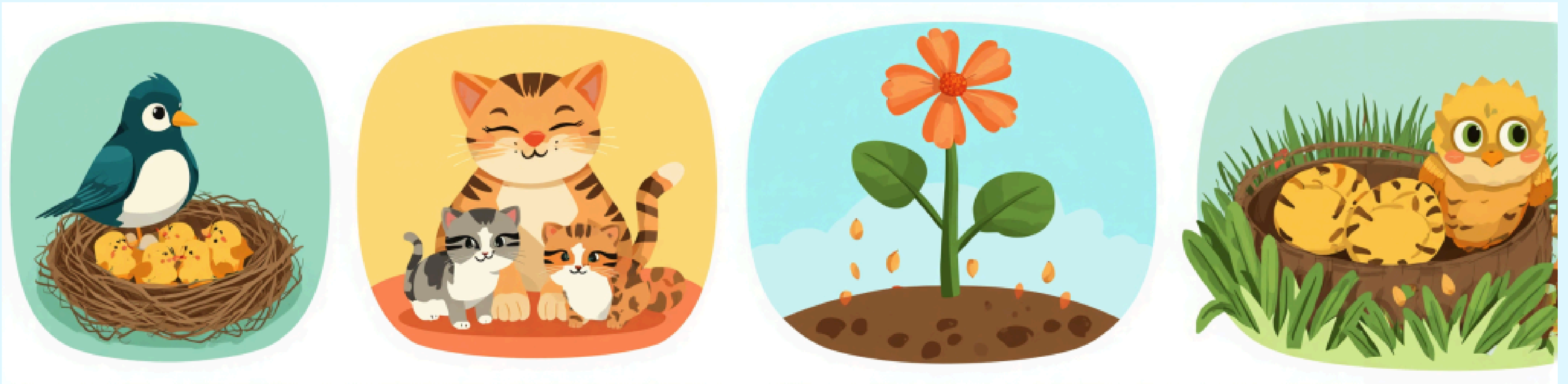
What is the plant responding to?

THE SUNLIGHT!



Life Process 3: Reproduction

Living things have babies or seeds so their kind continues.



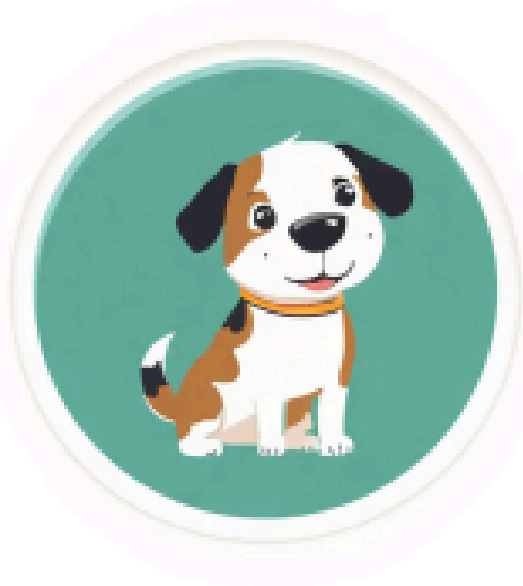
BIRDS LAY EGGS

CATS HAVE KITTENS

PLANTS MAKE SEEDS

Living or Nonliving?

Is it LIVING or NONLIVING? Point and guess!



Living



Nonliving



Living



Nonliving



Nonliving

THINK • PAIR • SHARE

Assessment Questions

1. Which is a living thing?

A.Chair B.Rock C.Tree D.Pencil

3. Which shows response?

A.Plant toward light B.Pencil on table
C.Stone on ground D.Book on shelf

5. Which is nonliving?

A.Bird B.Flower C.Cat D.Table

2. Which shows growth?

A.Seed becoming plant B.Book opening
C.Ball rolling D.Chair moving

4. Why do living things reproduce?

A.Become nonliving B.Continue their kind
C.Become smaller D.Stop growing

CIRCLE ONE ANSWER

Great Thinking!

1 • C — Tree

2 • A — Seed becoming plant

3 • A — Plant growing toward light

4 • B — To continue their kind

5 • D — Table



Key Takeaways & Goodbye!

Living things are special.

They GROW and CHANGE.

They RESPOND to their environment.

They REPRODUCE to continue their kind.

Plants, animals, and people are living things!

Keep exploring the amazing world of living things!

